

Dashboards are Dead

Bas Land

2026-01-29

Introduction

Bas Land

- Data consultant since 2013
- I’ve done Power Pivot, SQL Server, Power BI, Azure SQL, and now Fabric
- Partner @ Kimura, a Data & AI software and consultancy company
- Microsoft Dataplatform MVP
- Brazilian jiu-jitsu purple belt, weight lifter, runner
- Husband and father



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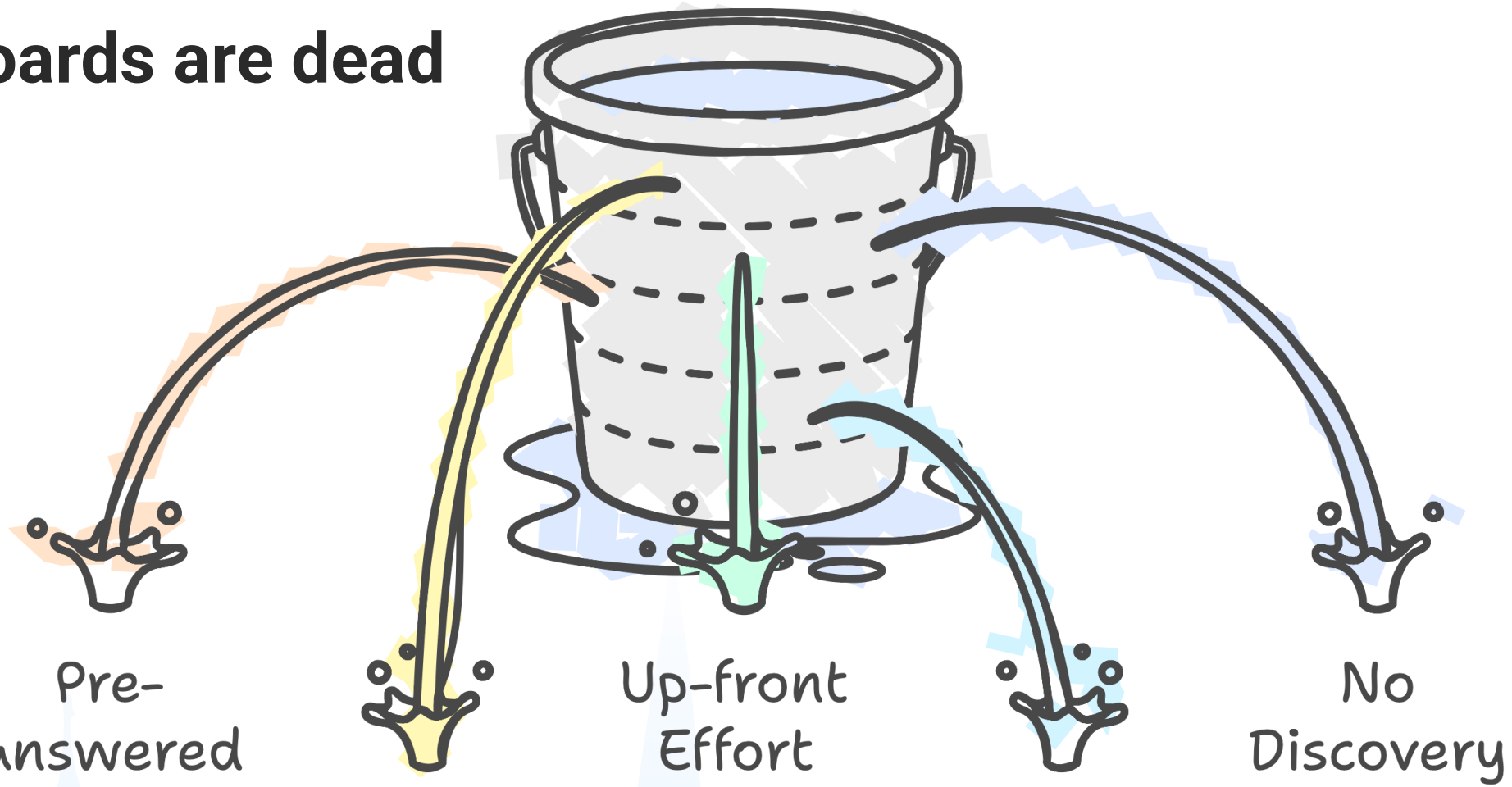


Slides and code samples

- The slides and code samples for this session will be posted to my public Github repo:
  - https://github.com/basland/presentations/
- Also check my YouTube and blog for content like this:
  - YouTube.com/@ThatFabricGuy
  - https://thatfabricguy.com

What are Fabric Data Agents?

Why dashboards are dead



Pre-answered Questions

Limits user inquiry

Repeatable Process

This is actually good!

Up-front Effort

High initial investment

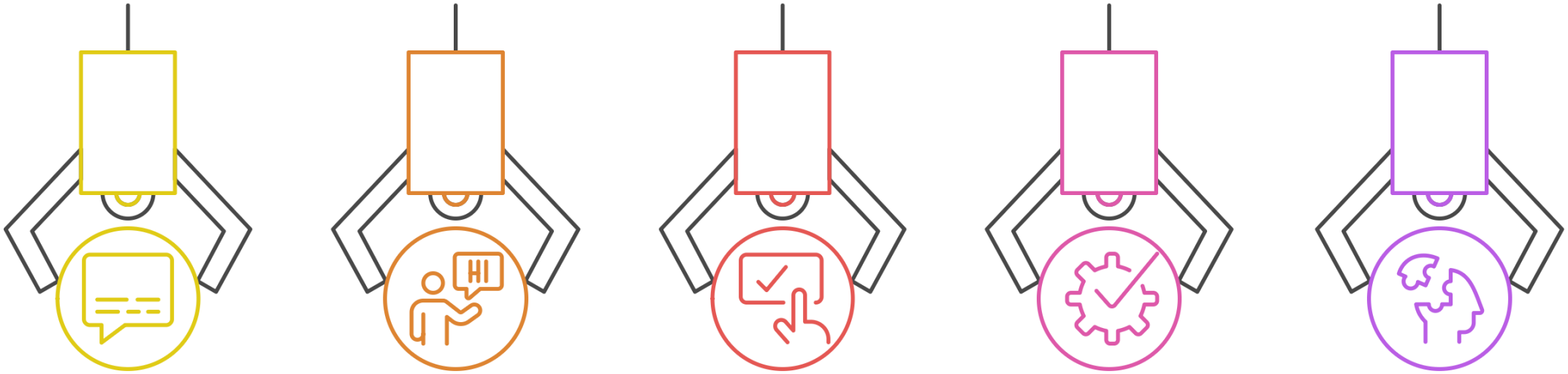
No Context

Hinders deeper understanding

No Discovery

Prevents new insights

Enter, Data Agents



Data Interface

Provides an interface to chat with your data.

Natural Language

Ask questions as if you were asking a colleague.

Minimal Effort

Requires minimal up-front effort to set up.

Setup Importance

Setup and instructions are important for proper use.

Data Combination

Combines your data with general knowledge and context.

Not a replacement for dashboards

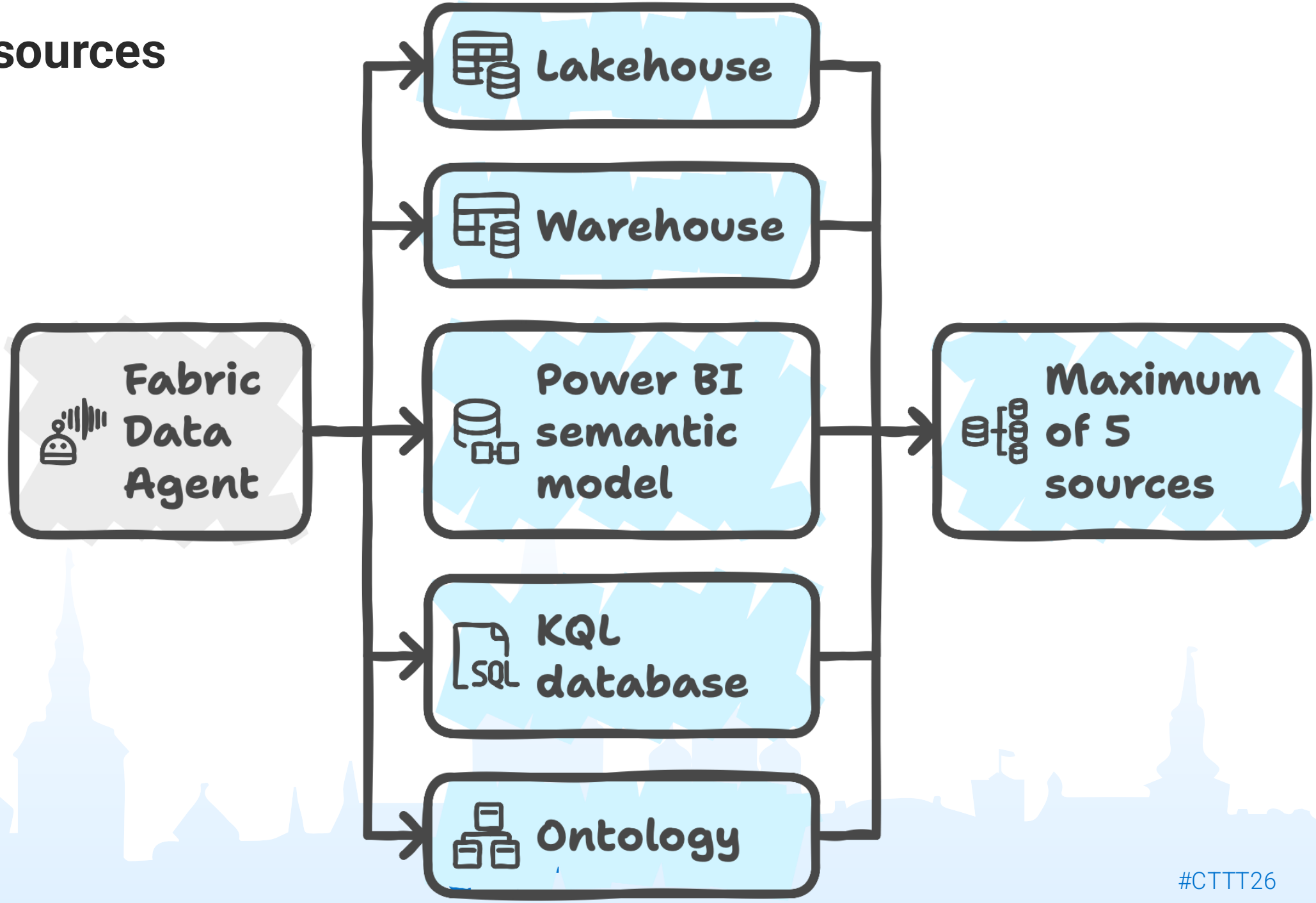
Pros

- Data discovery
- Interactive querying
- Minimal setup

Cons

- No deterministic repeatability
- AI hallucinations

Which data sources can we use?



Fabric Data Agent process



Natural Language Question

User asks a question in natural language

Pick Best Data Source

Data agent selects the most appropriate data source

Generate Query

Data agent converts the question into a query language (NL2SQL, NL2DAX, NL2KQL)

Validate Query

Data agent checks the query for accuracy and permissions

Execute Query

Data agent runs the query against the selected data source

Summarise Results

Data agent presents the query results in a concise summary

Checks and balances

Checks and Balances

Ensures user access is respected and maintains information security.

Responsible AI Checks

Mitigates risks associated with automated decision-making.

Read-Only Querying

Allows data access without alteration, preserving accuracy.







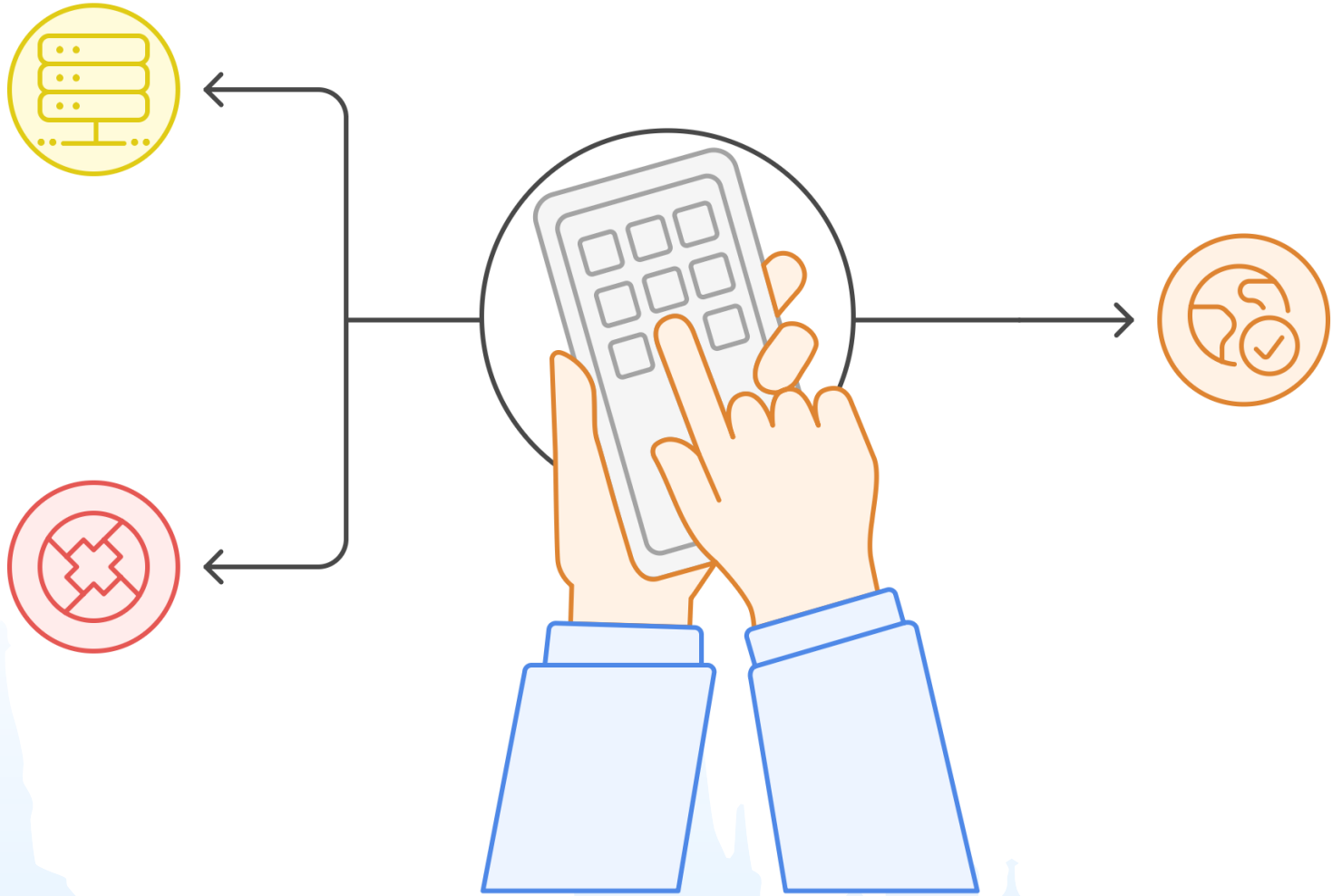
Prerequisites

Capacity Requirements

You need a capacity to use Data Agents.

XMLA Enabled

Enable XMLA if you use semantic models as a source.



Tenant Settings

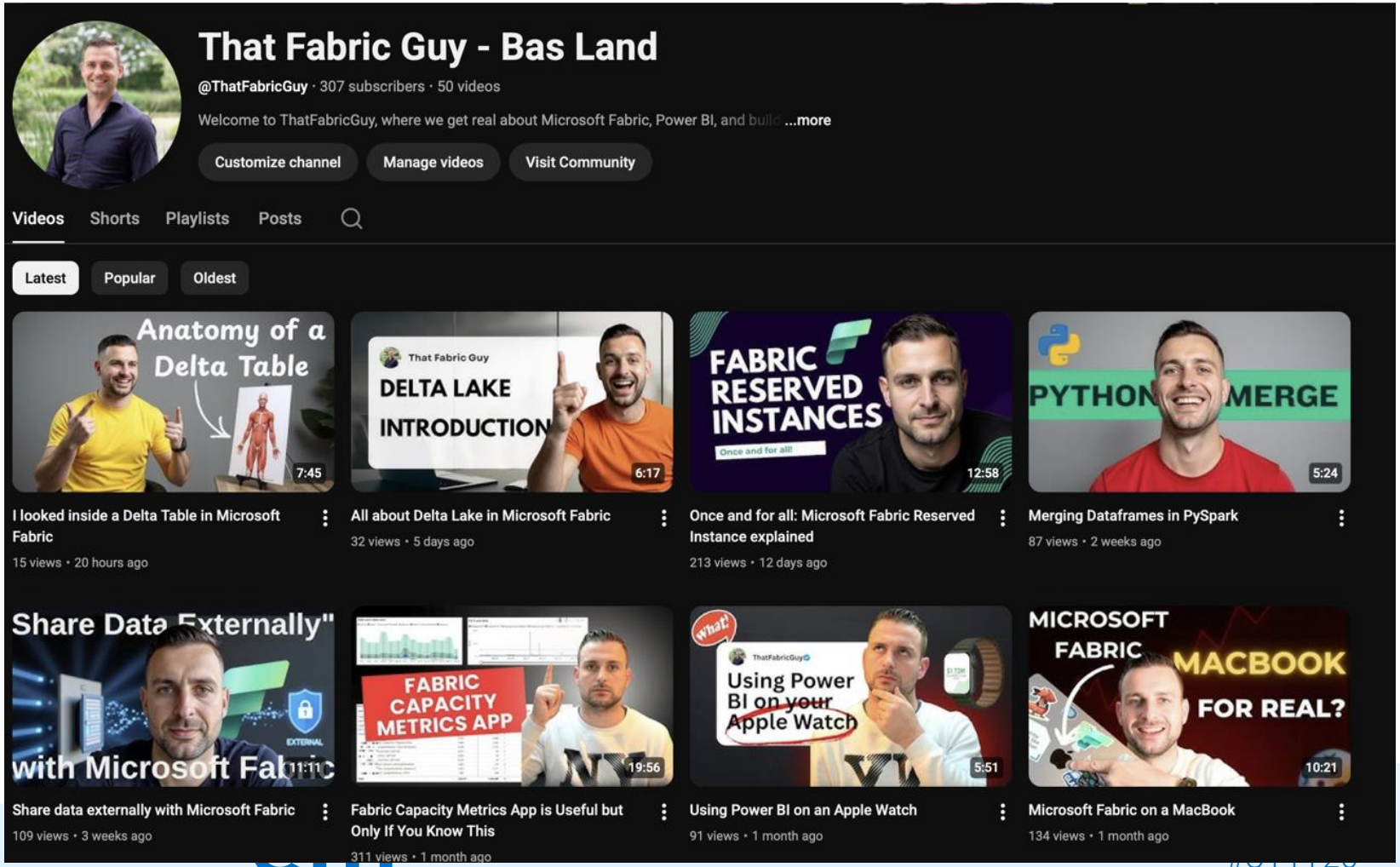
Enable cross-geo AI processing in tenant settings.


DEMO TIME!

Recap

- Data Agents are amazing for data discovery
- Setup is important though – work with instructions and sample queries
- Validate responses and tweak where needed
- AI can (and will) hallucinate. Don’t trust it blindly.

Follow my YouTube. Seriously!





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Thank you!

Q&A

